



FREE GUIDE · FOR DENTAL GROUPS & DSOs

The Dental Group / DSO Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Standardize sharps, amalgam, and meds
across every location.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

One standard, every location.

Dental groups and DSOs run the same dental waste streams as a single practice — sharps, amalgam, pharmaceutical, biohazard, and controlled — but the challenge is standardizing them consistently across every location, with centralized records. One rogue location handling amalgam wrong is a group-wide exposure. This guide covers every stream and how to standardize it.

The good news

One vendor can standardize disposal across all your locations — the same kits, the same process, centralized Certificates of Destruction — with amalgam recycling coordinated. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Sharps

Standardized sharps handling at every location.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles, carpules & blades
- Orthodontic wire
- Burs & broken instruments

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; high-volume sites should check daily.

WASTE STREAM 02

Dental amalgam & mercury

Amalgam is recycled, not incinerated — and the most common thing a location gets wrong. Standardize it group-wide.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Amalgam separator solids & scrap
- Spent amalgam capsules
- Extracted teeth with amalgam

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Red-bag / biohazard waste
- Sharps containers
- Regular trash or the drain

THE RULE · EPA Dental Amalgam Rule — ISO 11143 separators and recycling at every location; sewer discharge is prohibited.

DISPOSE WITH · Amalgam recycling, coordinated across your group.

Tip

Audit each location's separator and recycling — one non-compliant site is a group-wide exposure.

WASTE STREAM 03

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired anesthetics and non-controlled medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired anesthetics & antibiotics
- Non-controlled meds
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit or pickup.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Red-bag biohazard, standardized across sites.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze
- Contaminated PPE
- Extracted teeth without amalgam

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — over-classifying at volume is costly.

WASTE STREAM 05

Controlled substances

Any controlled substances stocked across the group.



GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V
- Wasted or partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, Form 222 for Schedule II transfers, Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance destruction, to DEA standards.

Tip

Diversion risk makes witnessed wasting logs and a clean paper trail non-negotiable.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The dental group / DSO compliance checklist.

- ☐ Every location uses the same sharps containers and process.
- ☐ Amalgam separators installed, maintained, and recycled at every site — audited group-wide.
- ☐ Expired meds segregated and destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Any controlled substances non-retrievable with Form 41.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens at every location.
- ☐ Centralized Certificates of Destruction for all sites, retained per state rules.

QUESTIONS DSOS ASK

Your DSO questions, answered.

How do you standardize disposal across all our locations?

The same kits, the same process, and centralized Certificates of Destruction for every site — so compliance doesn't depend on each office figuring it out.

How do we manage amalgam compliance at scale?

Every location needs an ISO 11143 separator and amalgam recycling. We coordinate recycling and help you audit each site — one non-compliant location is a group-wide risk.

Can we get one bill and one set of records?

Yes — centralized billing and documentation across all locations.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums; volume programs available.

THE EASY WAY**Handle it with mail-back.**

Easy Rx Cycle standardizes waste disposal across your entire group — the same mail-back kits (or scheduled pickup) at every location, amalgam recycling coordinated, and centralized Certificates of Destruction. No contract. See our single-practice detail in the Dental Practice's Guide.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit (standardized)
Dental amalgam & mercury	Amalgam recycling (coordinated)
Expired meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Biohazard / RMW	Biohazard mail-back kit
Controlled substances	Controlled / medication kit (Form 41)

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Multi-location groups usually want scheduled pickup and centralized records over per-office mail-back. Let's build it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY DENTAL GROUPS & DSOS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order



Ready to simplify your dental group waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop